DISCOVERY HAVEN

Discovery Haven: The Genesis Report (2025 – Feb 2026)

A Retrospective on Foundational Immersions, Experiential Pilots and the Proof-of-Concept Phase

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Table of Contents

DISCOVERY HAVEN

1. Executive Summary
2. Vision, Mission and Strategic Framework
3. Executive KPI Dashboard
4. Departmental Operations and Key Personnel
5. The Experiential Programme Archive
6. Transition to Full Operations and Operational Readiness
7. Conclusion

Report Map

1. Executive Summary

Discovery Haven was founded on a simple premise: children learn best when they are active participants rather than passive recipients. Between 2025 and April 2026, the organisation ran a deliberate proof-of-concept phase, referred to in this report as the Genesis Phase. A proof-of-concept is a small-scale, time-limited test designed to show that an idea works in practice before significant resources are committed to it. Our idea was that structured, hands-on, child-centric learning would be both pedagogically effective and in real demand among families.

During this period we delivered nine major experiential events to more than 185 children from 62 pioneer families. Repeat attendance reached 85.4%, post-event parent satisfaction averaged 94.8%, and no safety incidents were recorded across any indoor or outdoor activity. We also produced more than 520 photo and video assets and, most importantly, gathered the operational and pedagogical evidence needed to design a year-round academy.

The Genesis Phase concluded in late April 2026. In May 2026, Discovery Haven formally moved into full operations, launching its Academy Timetable, institutional partnerships and publishing initiatives. This report records what we did, what we measured, what we learned and how those lessons shaped the institution we are today.

> “Before we built the academy, we listened to the spark of curiosity in every child.”

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2. Vision, Mission and Strategic Framework

2.1 Mission

Discovery Haven exists to cultivate an articulate, courageous and intellectually agile generation of African youth. We pursue this by replacing passive, lecture-style learning with three things: studio-based skill mastery, experiential discovery and evidence-based curriculum design. In a studio model, children practise a skill by making, building, performing or testing something, with facilitators coaching them rather than simply instructing them.

2.2 Core Values

Child Centricity — Systems are designed around the child's agency, voice and individual cognitive pace. Children choose, question and lead parts of every session.

Scientific Rigor — Every creative activity is anchored in verified pediatric development frameworks and biostatistical research. Fun is never a substitute for evidence.

Authentic Identity — Stories, crafts and concepts are rooted in contemporary African life and modern urban realities, so children see themselves reflected in what they learn.

Playful Excellence — High standards of skill acquisition are maintained through joyful, immersive experiences. We hold that play and rigour reinforce each other.

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2.3 The Three Genesis Pillars

The Genesis Phase was organised around three pillars. Each carried a measurable target so that the pilot could be judged objectively.

1. Pilot Experiential Labs –

Testing high-concept themes (STEM, nature, literacy) in short-form event formats.

Target: 100% hands-on activity

2. Sensory & Tactile Learning –

Prioritising real-world interaction with materials, people and environments over screen-based instruction.

Target: 0% screen time

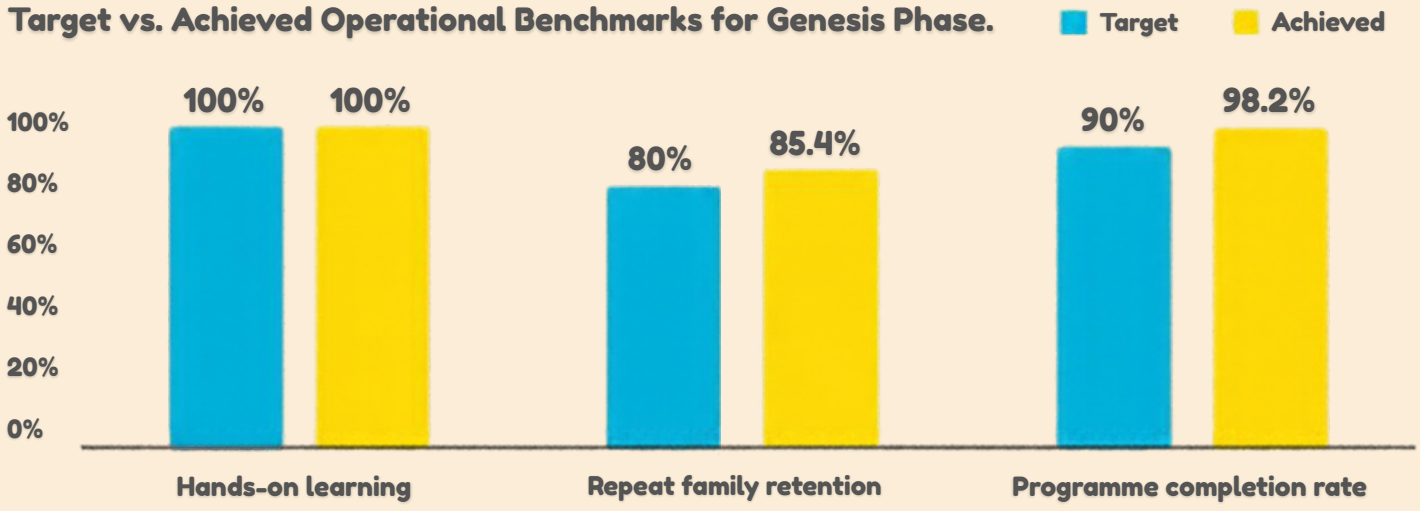
3. Community Proof-of-Concept –

Building trust with pioneer parents and securing early engagement metrics.

Target: 80%+ repeat retention

Performance against targets.

Target vs. Achieved Operational Benchmarks for Genesis Phase.



The retention result is the most strategically significant. A retention rate measures the share of families who return after their first experience. Families rarely return to something their children did not enjoy or that they did not trust, so a figure above target is a strong early indicator of genuine value.

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3. Executive KPI Dashboard

A Key Performance Indicator (KPI) is a measurable value showing how effectively an organisation is achieving a stated objective.

The table below summarises the headline results of the Genesis Phase.

Participant Reach	Total children enrolled across pilots	185+ participants
Community Growth	Total pioneer families engaged	62 families
Retention Rate	Repeat attendance (multi-event)	85.4%
Programme Output	Experiential pilot events delivered	9 major events
Media Assets	High-resolution photo and video archive	520+ assets
Parent Satisfaction	Post-event CSAT survey score	94.8% approval
Safety Record	Incidents across outdoor and indoor immersions	0 (100% safety)

CSAT (Customer Satisfaction Score) is the percentage of survey respondents who rated their experience positively. Here it reflects structured parent surveys administered after each event.

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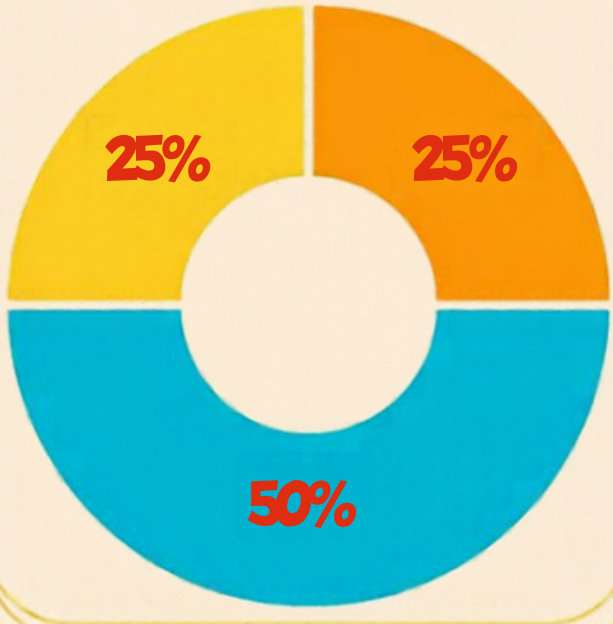
31 Who Participated

Discovery Haven serves children from ages 3 to 16, and the pilots were deliberately designed to test how different age groups respond to the same philosophy.

Half of all participants came from the Junior Track, with the Early Childhood and Senior Tracks each contributing a quarter.

Age Range	Track	Share of Participants
3–6 years	Early Childhood	25%
7–11 years	Junior Track	50%
12–16 years	Senior Track	25%

Participant Age Distribution Across Genesis Pilots.



This distribution tells us that our strongest early demand sits in the 7–11 range, while the substantial presence of both younger and older children confirms that the model can scale across the full age spectrum.

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4. Departmental Operations and Key Personnel

The pilots were delivered by four functional departments. Although small, each operated with defined responsibilities and measurable outputs.

Curriculum & Pedagogy

9 pilot frameworks designed and tested

Media, Brand & Visual Assets

520+ high-resolution media assets and 9 after-movies

Operations & Safety Governance

100% safety compliance across all nineimmersions

Community & Parent Relations

85%+ repeat attendance and 94.8% CSAT across 62 families

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4.1 Curriculum & Pedagogy (Research and Curriculum Architecture)

Led by the Lead Curriculum Developer, this department was responsible for deciding what children would learn and how. Pedagogy is the method and practice of teaching. The team used the pilots as a living laboratory, evaluating child engagement across eight experiential themes to determine the best session length, the most effective age groupings and the right facilitator-to-child ratio for each format.

Its principal output was the precursor to our 8 Core Learning Pillars, a framework that sets early benchmarks for social-emotional learning (SEL), the development of self-awareness, empathy, teamwork and emotional regulation, and for creative problem-solving. In total, nine pilot frameworks were designed and tested.

4.2 Media, Brand & Visual Assets

Led by the Creative Director and Brand Manager, this department documented the journey and defined how Discovery Haven looks and feels. It built a media library of over 520 high-resolution photographs, promotional graphics and recap videos and produced nine after-movies, one for each event.

The team also validated the organisation's signature visual identity: vibrant, warm, structured and distinctly modern African.

4.3 Operations & Safety Governance

Led by the Operations Manager and Logistics Lead, this department handled venues, schedules, supplies, supervision and risk management.

Working with children outdoors, around tools and in unfamiliar environments demands disciplined safety practice.

The department achieved 100% safety compliance across all nine immersions, and in doing so stress-tested the workflows, safety protocols and venue-management procedures that now underpin the academy.

100% safety

4.4 Community & Parent Relations

Led by the Community Engagement Officer, this department managed communication with families and maintained the feedback loop.

Structured post-event surveys were used to refine safety protocols, venue selection and activity pacing.

The department sustained an 85%+ repeat attendance rate among families in seasonal events and a 94.8% CSAT rating across 62 families.

94.8% CSAT

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5. The Experiential Programme Archive

This section documents the nine foundational events that formed the bedrock of Discovery Haven before full operations began in May 2026. They are grouped into three categories.

A. Exploration & STEM Immersions | **B. Seasonal & Play Immersions** | **C. Craft & Wilderness Expeditions**

Programme	Core Focus	Timeframe	Attendance	CSAT
Adventures in Amazonia	Nature & Environmental SEL	2025	28	96%
Metro to Mars Exploration	Applied STEM & Spatial Logic	2025	32	95%
Stories in the Wild	Outdoor Literacy & Drama	2025	25	94%
Festive Fantasy (Seasons 1–3)	Expressive Arts & Community	2025-2026	54 (cumulative)	98%
Spark of Curiosity Playdate	Early Childhood Play Labs	2026	18	93%
Base Camp Adventures	Outdoor Survival & Teamwork	2026	22	97%
Clay & Culture Craft	Fine Motor & Cultural Arts	2026	20	95%

Festive Fantasy ran across three seasonal editions, which accounts for nine events from seven programme titles.

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5.1 Adventures in Amazonia (2025)

Focus: Environmental science, ecosystem discovery and nature-based sensory play.

Attendance: 28 • CSAT: 96%

Children entered an immersive rainforest environment designed to engage touch, sight and smell. They examined plant biodiversity, which is the variety of plant life within an ecosystem, and used magnifying glasses to study leaves, seeds and textures. They also created eco-crafts and discussed why protecting wildlife matters. Instead of being told that ecosystems are interconnected, children worked in groups to solve problems that showed it.

The event fostered environmental stewardship, a sense of personal responsibility for the natural world, along with collaborative group problem-solving.

5.2 Metro to Mars Exploration (2025)

Focus: Space science, basic physics and imaginative engineering.

Attendance: 32 • CSAT: 95%

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Attendance: 32 • CSAT: 95%

This high-concept STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics) immersion simulated a journey from a modern urban transit system to a planetary base on Mars. The framing linked the everyday experience of city commuting with the ambitious idea of space travel. Children built miniature rover models, including cardboard designs fitted with solar panels, and tackled space-colony challenges such as power supply and terrain navigation.

Junior explorers showed high engagement in critical thinking and spatial logic, the ability to reason about about shapes, positions and movement in space.

5.3 Stories in the Wild Exploration (2025)

Focus: Outdoor literacy, oral storytelling and drama.

Attendance: 25 • CSAT: 94%

Staged in a park, this event moved reading out of the classroom. Children gathered on blankets under open skies to read, act out character scenes and build original group narratives inspired by their surroundings. A storyteller guided the circle, but the children shaped the stories themselves.

The event showed that non-traditional outdoor settings can accelerate children's interest in literacy.

B. Seasonal & Play Immersions

These events focused on community, creativity and the particular needs of younger children.

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5.4 Festive Fantasy, Seasons 1, 2 and 3 (2025-2026)

Focus: Creative arts, festive performance and family community building.

Cumulative attendance: 54 • CSAT: 98%

Our signature multi-season holiday series ran from late 2025 into early 2026. Each edition included holiday crafting, interactive music sessions, gift creation and community storytelling. Families came to celebrate together, which made this series the heart of our early community. It earned the highest satisfaction score of time phase.

Three seasonal editions built a loyal core community of more than 50 families and underpinned our 85%-repeat-attendance rate.

5.5 Spark of Curiosity Playdate (2026)

Focus: Early childhood social-emotional play labs and foundational motor skills.

Attendance: 18 • CSAT: 93%

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5.6

Base Camp Adventures (2026)

Focus: Outdoor survival skills, basic navigation and self-reliance. Attendance: 22 · CSAT: 97%

A team-based outdoor expedition in which participants learned knot-tying, map-reading, shelter building and group safety protocols. Children pitched a mini-tent together and practised camp knots, tasks that need clear communication and shared responsibility.

KEY OUTCOME

The expedition boosted personal independence, resilience and peer communication under active conditions.

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5.7 Clay & Culture Craft (2026)

This workshop celebrated traditional and contemporary African pottery and sculpture. Children worked with raw clay to mould functional art and storytelling artefacts. Shaping clay strengthens fine motor coordination, the precise small-muscle control used in writing and detailed handwork, while connecting children to a living cultural heritage.

Focus: Cultural appreciation, fine motor coordination and tactile sculpting.

Attendance: 20 - CSAT: 95%

KEY OUTCOME

The workshop deepened cultural appreciation and tactile creative expression.

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6. Transition to Full Operations and Operational Readiness

6.1 What the Pilots Taught Us

The nine pilot events produced three principal insights.

1

Demand validation.

Short weekend events demonstrated clear demand for structured, year-round learning frameworks. Families who attended one event frequently came back for the next, and many asked what was available in between.

2

Curriculum evolution.

Each single-day event concept supplied a pedagogical blueprint for a full-length academy module, including Curiosity Box, EQ Lab, Creative Quest and Loud & Fearless. The pilots effectively served as prototypes for the academy curriculum.

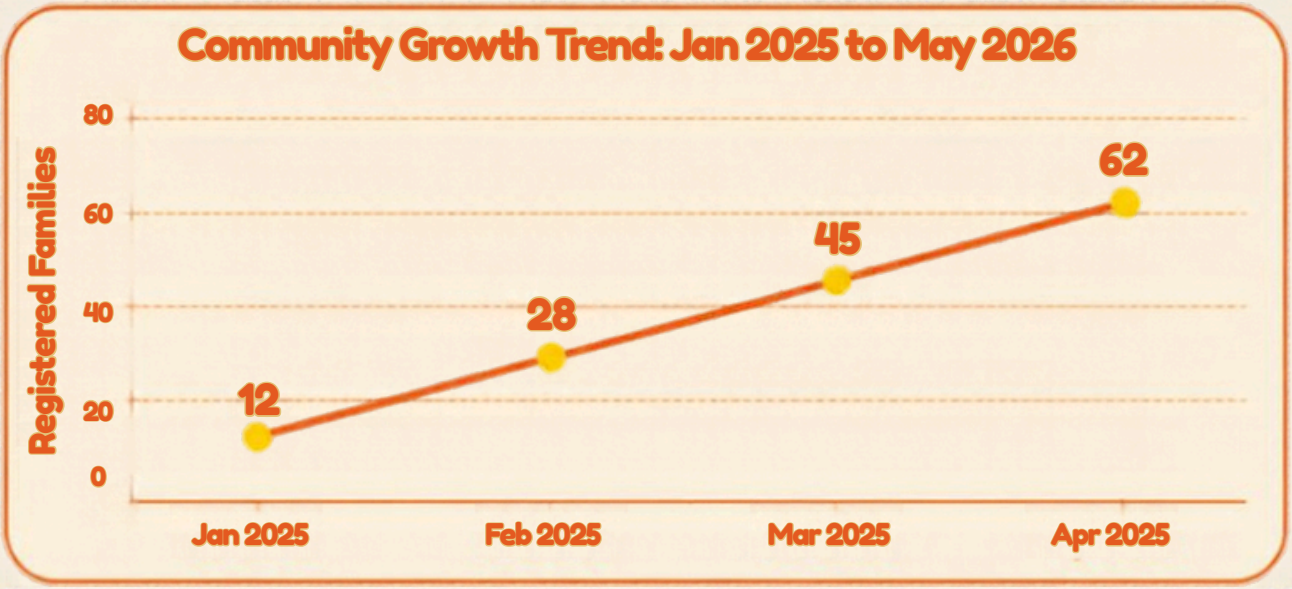
3

Operational readiness.

Administrative workflows, media-capture systems, safety protocols and venue-management procedures were fully stress-tested and refined under real conditions with real families.

6.2 Community Growth

Registered families grew steadily from the start of 2025 to the eve of the academy launch, moving from 12 to 28 to 45 to 62 families. This steady, compounding growth, driven largely by word-of-mouth from satisfied pioneer parents, gave us confidence that demand was organic rather than a one-time spike.



6.3 Operational Readiness Checklist

Before the May 2026 launch, each operational area was assessed against a defined readiness standard.

Curriculum Frameworks	100%	Finalised & vetted
Venue Partnerships	100%	Secured
Facilitator Network	100%	Trained
Media Infrastructure	100%	Operational
Academy Calendar	100%	Scheduled (May–Dec 2026)

6.4

The Bridge to Full Operations

By late April 2026, the foundational phase had reached its successful conclusion. Discovery Haven emerged from the Genesis period not merely as an event organiser but as a fully developed educational institute. In May 2026, it officially transitioned into full operations, opening the year-round Academy Timetable, institutional partnerships and flagship publishing initiatives.

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7. Conclusion

The Genesis Phase set out to answer one question: will families embrace a learning model built on experience, curiosity and cultural authenticity? The evidence says yes.

The pilots delivered strong engagement, high satisfaction, a spotless safety record and a growing community, and they gave us the operational and curricular foundations to build on.

We thank every parent, facilitator and young explorer who joined us at the beginning.

Discovery Haven
2025-2026 Video Archive

wwwdiscoveryhaven.org

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Nurturing the Courage to Think, Create, and Lead.

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